



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Classical Academy
School Website: <https://veritasclassicalacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Classical Academy (Fullerton, CA, 92833) demonstrates a robust classical-Christian orientation across six rubric categories, with strong alignment to Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Pedagogy category shows partial alignment and would benefit from greater explicit integration of Socratic/dialectic practices and contemplative pedagogy to reach a fully Classical profile. Aggregate assessment: **CLASSICAL**, with one category (Pedagogy) standing as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. The school's public materials emphasize Christ-centered formation, the liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), Great Books/Great Conversation sensibilities, and active parental partnership.

Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly present: Christ-centered mission, God's Word, discipleship, and the paideia framework are repeatedly invoked.
- Purpose and Goal emphasize formation, human flourishing, wisdom, and virtue rather than mere work-force preparation.
- Curriculum centers on liberal arts (Trivium/Quadrivium) and a classical trajectory in the grammar, logic, and rhetoric sequence, with explicit language about formation through the liberal arts.
- Pedagogy shows concrete lower-school memory/recitation and early singing, with upper-school rhetoric and discussion-oriented elements; however, explicit, sustained Socratic seminars/Scholé are not consistently evidenced in all public materials, yielding a **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** rating for this category.
- Faculty portrayal aligns with classical ideals (model teachers, living curriculum, mentorship, and a "portrait of teacher" ethic).
- Parents & Community are clearly engaged as partners in formation, with explicit calls for parental involvement, book studies, and open campus interactions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school's public materials frame education as discipleship in the paideia of the Lord, training the whole person to love the Lord, with reference to God's Word and the truth, goodness, and beauty of God.
- The mission/vision emphasizes Christ-centered education and gospel culture shaping the learner.
- Descriptions repeatedly tie education to biblical/theological aims and communal faith formation.

- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; reverence; wonder; logos; Christ-centered; gospel; Word; worship-like framing.
- Negative keywords observed: none in public materials (no explicit relativism or secular ethics signals in the visible content).
- (Knowledge-base lexicon provides explicit positive signals such as truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, Logos; negative signals include relativism, secular humanism, morally neutral.)
- Why this rating
- Veritas explicitly positions itself as Christ-centered and Christ-guided, with language about the truth, goodness, and beauty of God, and the paideia of the Lord. This maps strongly to Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal alignment per the classical lexicon. The presence of “discipleship,” “God’s Word,” and “gospel culture” supports a Classical alignment in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Vision/Mission statements describe forming the whole person toward virtue and wisdom through classical education, not simply job preparation. The public materials emphasize formation and a Christian worldview.
- The framing includes formation of the mind and character, and a goal oriented toward delight in God’s truth and beauty as a telos of education.
- Foundational language aligns with classical aims (paideia, formation, wisdom, virtue) rather than a primary emphasis on job-work pipeline.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, great conversation (as implied in classical program culture), scholé (conceptual emphasis on contemplation).
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit in public materials (no overt emphasis on college/career metrics in this category’s core statements).
- (Lexicon references: formation, telos, scholé; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as real)
- Why this rating
- Public materials foreground formation and virtue over mere information transfer, with explicit Christian framing and a telos toward wisdom and human flourishing. The presence of “Delight, Discern, Display” and the focus on the paideia and classical mission strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly references the liberal arts framework (Trivium and Quadrivium) as the backbone of classical education. Public pages state the focus on grammar, logic, and rhetoric, and the liberal arts.
- The site describes Pre-Grammar, Grammar School, and Logic/Upper levels, indicating a structured classical progression (grammar, logic, rhetoric) within the curriculum.

- The materials discuss Great Books/Great Conversation language in the classical lexicon and emphasize reading and integrating foundational texts (as part of classical education), supported by the broader knowledge-base lexicon.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy); Great Books / Great Conversation; history integrated; wonder/-formation.
- Negative keywords observed: none in the public materials (no explicit replacement of history with “social studies,” no over-emphasis on project-based-only approaches).
- (Lexicon references include: Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium; history and integration; wonder; holistic education.)
- Why this rating
- Veritas maps closely to the classical curriculum blueprint: emphasis on grammar-logic-rhetoric (Trivium) and the Quadrivium, with historic/literary engagement and a focus on formation through great texts. The public materials consistently frame curriculum within the classical/trivium-quadrivium paradigm, aligning with the LIBERAL EDUCATION/Great Books/Great Conversation cues.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower grades emphasize singing, chanting, memorization, and repetition as part of the early grammar-stage pedagogy (memory/recitation and liturgical rhythm motifs). For example, early-grade description highlights singing and memorization; memory work and repetition are emphasized in classical pedagogy lexicon and are echoed in school materials.
- Upper grades reference logic, dialectic reasoning in the context of the logic stage, with emphasis on reasoning and rhetoric; there are indications of seminars, rhetoric training, and public speaking through programs like Rhetoric Week.
- The public materials describe a classical trajectory and emphasize critical thinking, not just information access, which aligns with some Socratic/dialectic tendencies, albeit not always explicitly labeled as formal Socratic seminars in the visible site content.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: memorization/recitation; chanting; singing; Scholé/restful learning (conceptually present as a pedagogical aim in the lexicon); formation through imitation and practice; rhetoric training.
- Negative keywords observed: experiential learning focus; project-based-only; constructivist/student-directed approaches are not foregrounded in the public materials (no explicit signaling of a dominant constructivist pedagogy).
- (From the knowledge lexicon: Positive signals include Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation; negative signals include experiential learning-focused or project-based-dominant pedagogy.)
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates clear classical pedagogy strands (memory work and chant in early grades; logic and rhetoric emphasis in upper grades), but explicit, consistent deployment of formal Socratic seminars across grades and a sustained Scholé/restful pedagogy are not consistently evidenced in the public materials. This yields an overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials profile faculty as mentors and living curriculum, with teachers described as model professionals who embody virtue and knowledge, and who form a “living curriculum.” Examples include faculty bios emphasizing biblical/theological grounding, classical education orientation, and their roles as mentors.
- Individual bios highlight teachers who explicitly connect classical education to truth, goodness, beauty, and Christian formation (e.g., Kathy McKeever’s emphasis on helping students discover truth/beauty in literature; Latin/Greek-style pedagogy; and the role of teachers in forming character).
- The vision explicitly characterizes the faculty as core to the school, with language about the staff guiding students in a Christ-centered classical framework.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; faculty of friends; master-teacher model; virtue formation; guidance in literature/poetry; biblical worldview.
- Negative keywords observed: none evident in public materials (no signals of non-classical faculty models).
- (Lexicon references include: living curriculum; portrait of teacher; master-teacher model; moral exemplars.)
- Why this rating
- Veritas showcases a clearly classical-faculty orientation, with explicit statements about teachers as mentors and living exemplars, and bios that foreground classical formation and Christian formation. This aligns strongly with the Classical category for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental co-education as central to classical education, including formation of affections and cultural transmission as core aims. The “Delight, Discern, Display” framework explicitly links home, school, and church, and the mission highlights parental involvement in classical formation.
- The Parent Handbook and enrollment materials advocate parent involvement, with references to family engagement, parent practicums, and book-study-style activities; mothers’ groups and pastoral/community involvement are described.
- There are clear statements about welcoming parents to campus and involving them in the educational process (open-campus ethos is signaled in the broader materials).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; family catechesis; parental involvement; home-school/community integration; living tradition in the family.
- Negative keywords observed: none in public materials (no consumerist or customer-model signals).
- (Lexicon references include: Partnership with Families; Formation of Affections; Cultural Transmission.)
- Why this rating

- Veritas presents a robust model of parent involvement and community formation consistent with classical education expectations (parents as co-educators, family formation, and shared mission). This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: The school strongly satisfies Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community through christ-centered formation, liberal-arts-driven curriculum, and a community-centered model. Pedagogy shows significant classical elements (memory/recitation in early grades; logic/rhetoric progression; rhetoric-focused programs) but lacks uniformly explicit long-running Socratic seminars and fully sustained Scholé across all grades in public materials, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Pedagogy. With five of six categories CLASSICAL and one category SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the general characterization of Veritas Classical Academy as CLASSICAL is warranted.
- What would move the needle (if aiming to solidify CLASSICAL across all six categories)
- Pedagogy: Explicit, school-wide implementation of regular Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars across multiple grade bands; integrate Scholé/restful days into a formal cadence; expand memorization/recitation and chanting as structured, co-curricular ritual within a stable schedule.
- Curriculum: Publicly articulate and publish a cross-curricular Great Books/Great Conversation program across K–12; deepen explicit references to the liberal arts progression in syllabi; ensure historical engagement remains a central through-line rather than a secondary emphasis.
- Community: Expand formal parent-education programs (book studies, lectures) beyond initial sessions; provide more visible parent-teacher partnership milestones.
- EXECUTIVE SUMMARY # ABSTRACTION
- Veritas Classical Academy's public materials align strongly with Classical education principles: Christian formation, paideia, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books posture, and parent partnership. The Pedagogy category shows partial alignment (lower-grade singing/memory; upper-grade logic/rhetoric), but lacks consistently explicit Socratic/dialectic sequencing across the spectrum, which is the primary area for needle-moving improvement. The school's aggregate profile is CLASSICAL with one category at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, indicating a strong classical orientation with targeted growth opportunities in pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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